Anhui Huang

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Education

2027 **University of California, Berkeley**
Ph.D.(expected), Philosophy
Committee: John MacFarlane (co-chair), Seth Yalcin (co-chair), Line Mikkelsen

2020 **Williams College**
B.A. Philosophy, with Honors & Phi Beta Kappa
Thesis advisor: Bojana Mladenovic

2018–19 **Williams-Exeter Program at Oxford University**

Areas of Research

AOS Epistemology, Language

AOC Mind, Logic, Decision Theory, Philosophy of Fiction, Early Modern

Under Review

What It Takes to Be Sure

Collective Inquiry and Expiring Assertion

Expressing Uncertainty

Publications

2021 Mere Subjectivism? Kant's Transcendental Deduction and the Hegelian Criticism (with Justin Shaddock)
Proceedings of the 13th International Kant Congress

Dissertation: Settled Questions, Certain Minds

When you tell me you aren't sure who won the last Dutch election, it is natural for me to infer that you have *something* in mind that bears on the matter—perhaps you have a guess, remember overhearing someone else discuss the election, or know a bit about Dutch politics in general. This simple observation—that your denial of certainty seems to communicate that you have some opinion on the matter—has been overlooked in the extensive literature on certainty. I argue that this phenomenon is not an isolated feature of certainty reports, but rather a symptom of a deeper problem with the dominant view of certainty, which identifies it with maximal credence. I propose instead that certainty is taking inquiry into a question to be closed. The inquiry view of certainty explains this phenomenon while also having a range of independent attractions. For example, be-

cause inquiry can be practical or theoretical, my view explains how we can be certain about both decisions and judgments. Further, my view leads to a novel view of assertion: whereas certainty involves treating one's own inquiry as closed, assertion involves proposing to treat collective inquiry as closed. I show that this view dissolves a long-standing puzzle about assertion and provides us with a deeper understanding of the relationships between assertion, inquiry, and certainty.

Talks

What It Takes to Be Sure (various titles)

APA Eastern Colloquium	January 2027
Department Colloquium, Williams College*	May 2026
Notre Dame/Northwestern Graduate Epistemology Conference	May 2026

Collective Inquiry and Expiring Assertion

Central New York Philosophy of Language Workshop	October 2025

Mere Subjectivism? Kant's Transcendental Deduction and the Hegelian Criticism

International Kant Congress in Oslo (with Justin Shaddock)	August 2019

**=invited; all others refereed.*

Comments

A Four-Dimensional Descartes, Bobby Johnson

UC Santa Cruz Graduate Metaphysics Workshop	May 2026

Disagreement and Meaning, John Macfarlane

Berkeley Kadish Workshop in Law, Philosophy, and Political Theory	September 2024

Fellowships and Awards

2025	Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2020-23	Regents Fellowship for Graduate Study, UC Berkeley
2020	Carol Lee Price Fellowship, UC Berkeley
2020	Versenyi Prize for Senior Going to Graduate School, Williams College
2020	Miller Prize for Outstanding Senior in Philosophy, Williams College
2019	Phi Beta Kappa, Williams College

Teaching

Primary Instructor

University of California, Berkeley

Summer 2024 Nature of Mind

Assistant Instructor

University of California, Berkeley

Fall 2026	Existentialism in Film and Literature	Andreja Novakovic
Spring 2026	Probability and Induction	Snow Zhang
Spring 2025	Philosophical Methods	Shamik Dasgupta
Spring 2024	Philosophical Methods	Shamik Dasgupta
Fall 2023	Philosophy of Language	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2022	Introduction to Logic	Seth Yalcin
Summer 2022	Introduction to Logic	Erica Klempner
Spring 2022	Philosophical Methods	Geoffery Lee
Fall 2021	Nature of Mind	John Campbell

Williams College

Fall 2019	Personal identity	Bojana Mladenovic
Spring 2018	History of Modern Philosophy	Justin Shaddock

Sinoway International Summer School, Shanghai

Summer 2017	Introduction to Philosophy	Keith McPartland
Summer 2017	Classical Western Philosophy	Keith McPartland

Service

2023-present	Minorities and Philosophy UC Berkeley Chapter Coordinator
2025-present	Epistemology Reading Group Organizer
2023-26	Wellness Committee
2023-25	Philosophy of Language Reading Group Organizer
2022-23	Department Colloquia Grad Organizer
2020-21	PhilGem Organizer

Graduate Coursework

Qualifying Exams

Spring 2023	Fiction	Olivia Bailey
Spring 2023	Disagreement	John MacFarlane
Spring 2023	Lying	Seth Yalcin

Courses

**=audited; all others for credit.*

Spring 2026	Explaining Action*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2026	Probability*	Ezra Rubenstein & Snow Zhang
Spring 2024	Belief*	John Macfarlane
Spring 2023	Sellars*	John MacFarlane
Fall 2023	Contextualism*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2022	Sentimentalism	Olivia Bailey

Spring 2022	Aristotle	Timothy Clarke
Fall 2022	Information and Knowledge*	Seth Yalcin
Spring 2021	Theory of Meaning*	John Campbell
Spring 2021	Belief, Credence, and Reasons*	John MacFarlane
Spring 2021	Imagination	Olivia Bailey
Spring 2021	Pragmatism	Shamik Dasgupta
Fall 2021	Population Ethics	Johahn Frick
Fall 2021	The Common Ground	John MacFarlane & Seth Yalcin
Fall 2020	Modal Logic	Wesley Holliday
Fall 2020	Philosophy of Language*	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2020	Conditionals*	Seth Yalcin
Fall 2020	First-Year Seminar	John Campbell & Hannah Ginsborg

References

Olivia Bailey
Assistant Professor of Philosophy
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John Campbell
Willis S. and Marion Slusser Professor of Philosophy
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Seth Yalcin
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Xueyin (Snow) Zhang (Teaching Reference)
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